

Ice breaker

News and Trends in cybersecurity

1. Palo Alto launches new AI-driven security platforms.

Palo Alto Network has rolled out updates versions of Cortex Cloud 2.0 and Prisma Prisma AIRS 2.0, embedding AI agents with human in the loop controls to proactively detect and mitigate threats.

2. AI-driven cybercrime rising in Japan.

AI-optimized cybercrime is rapidly increasing in Japan, with criminals leveraging advanced technology to scale attacks and exploit vulnerabilities, reports the Japan Times.

CrowdStrike's 2025 Asia Pacific cybercrime report says India, Australia and Japan are the countries most represented on

data extortion and ransomware dedicated leak sites (DLSS). These marketplace enable trading of sensitive data and access, greatly increasing risk for both organisations and individuals.

Earlier in October, Japan's largest brewer Asahi restarted operations at its Super Dry factories after a cyber attack shut down the majority of the group's 30 domestic factories.

3. Nigeria/Africa in spotlight for cyber readiness concerns.

Microsoft has warned that Africa is underprepared for escalating cyber threats, particularly in its private sector. Meanwhile, Nigeria's Data Protection Commission has been actively pushing awareness and resilience campaigns (e.g Summits in Kano).

The theme was "Striking a balance between data needs for AI training and Data Privacy".

Key outcome was the proposal to establish a student "Privacy Club", aimed at nurturing data protection awareness and advocacy among students in tertiary institutions.

Prompt for audience inputs:

Considering this recent warning to Africa and Nigeria what do you think the NPDC isn't doing right, or ought to do be more prepared to escalate cyber threats with the private sector playing a major role.